

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1102

By Pearson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Joe Calhoun, Operations Manager of the Ernest Withers Collection Museum & Gallery.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those exemplary citizens whose professional achievements and civic contributions have enriched the cultural and historical fabric of the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Joe Calhoun serves with distinction as Operations Manager of the Ernest Withers Collection Museum & Gallery in Memphis, an institution dedicated to preserving and sharing one of the most significant photographic archives documenting the Civil Rights Movement and the cultural history of the American South; and

WHEREAS, the Ernest Withers Collection Museum & Gallery houses the extraordinary photographic work of the late Dr. Ernest C. Withers, whose camera documented pivotal moments in American history, including the Civil Rights Movement, the Memphis sanitation workers' strike, the life of Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., and the vibrant cultural life of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, through his leadership and commitment, Joe Calhoun has played a vital role in the daily operations, programming, and stewardship of this historic institution, ensuring that the powerful stories captured through the lens of Ernest Withers remain accessible to students, scholars, residents, and visitors from around the world; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Calhoun's dedication to historic preservation and public education helps ensure that future generations may learn from the struggles, triumphs, and cultural contributions that have shaped the city of Memphis and the nation; and

WHEREAS, through his professionalism, passion for history, and unwavering commitment to community engagement, Joe Calhoun exemplifies the very best of public service and cultural stewardship; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly recognize Mr. Calhoun for his meaningful contributions to preserving the historical narrative of Memphis and honoring the legacy of one of Tennessee's most important chroniclers of history; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Joe Calhoun, Operations Manager of the Ernest Withers Collection Museum & Gallery, for his outstanding service, dedication to historic preservation, and commitment to sharing the rich cultural legacy of Memphis.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.